

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND FIVE YEAR PLANS

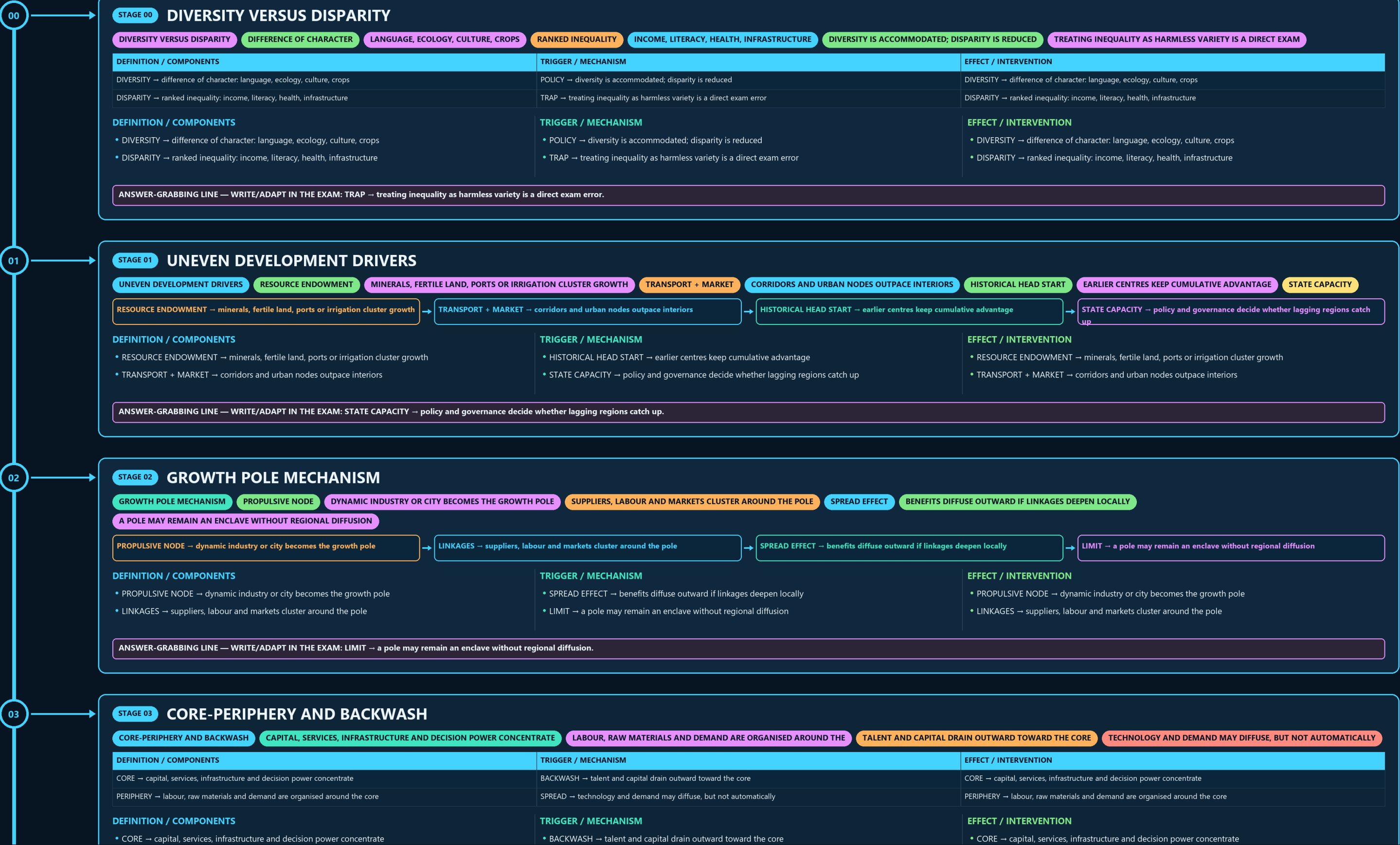
DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY → UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS → GROWTH POLE MECHANISM → CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH → PLANNING REGION CRITERIA → INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g4 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion.

STAGE 03 CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH

CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH CAPITAL, SERVICES, INFRASTRUCTURE AND DECISION POWER CONCENTRATE LABOUR, RAW MATERIALS AND DEMAND ARE ORGANISED AROUND THE TALENT AND CAPITAL DRAIN OUTWARD TOWARD THE CORE TECHNOLOGY AND DEMAND MAY DIFFUSE, BUT NOT AUTOMATICALLY

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate	BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core	CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core	SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically	PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core
DEFINITION / COMPONENTS - CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate - PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core	TRIGGER / MECHANISM - BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core - SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically	EFFECT / INTERVENTION - CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate - PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically.

STAGE 04 PLANNING REGION CRITERIA

PLANNING REGION CRITERIA FUNCTIONAL UNITY FLOWS AND LINKAGES HOLD THE REGION TOGETHER ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY POLICY MUST ACTUALLY BE IMPLEMENTABLE ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY STRATEGY AND RESOURCE BASE MUST ALIGN SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together	ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align	FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable	SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success	ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable
DEFINITION / COMPONENTS - FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together - ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable	TRIGGER / MECHANISM - ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align - SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success	EFFECT / INTERVENTION - FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together - ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success.

STAGE 05 INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE NATIONAL PLANNING COMMITTEE BEGINS THE PLANNING IMAGINATION PLANNING COMMISSION SET UP AND FIRST PLAN LAUNCHED ANNUAL PLANS AFTER WAR, DROUGHT AND MACRO STRESS TWELFTH PLAN LAST CYCLE; NITI REPLACES PLANNING COMMISSION

1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination	1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched	1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress	2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission
SYSTEM / DEFINITION 1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched	PROCESS / MECHANISM 1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission	SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN 1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination 1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched	HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE 1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission.

STAGE 06 FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN

FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN FIRST PLAN IRRIGATION, AGRICULTURE, REFUGEE RESETTLEMENT, POWER SECOND PLAN HEAVY INDUSTRY AND PUBLIC-SECTOR INDUSTRIAL BASE SPATIAL LOGIC AGRARIAN RECOVERY FIRST, INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION NEXT

DO NOT SWAP THE PRIORITIES OF THE TWO PLANS

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power	SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next	FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base	TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans	SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base
DEFINITION / COMPONENTS - FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power - SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base	TRIGGER / MECHANISM - SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next - TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans	EFFECT / INTERVENTION - FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power - SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans.

06

STAGE 06

FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN

FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLANFIRST PLANIRRIGATION, AGRICULTURE, REFUGEE RESETTLEMENT, POWERSECOND PLANHEAVY INDUSTRY AND PUBLIC-SECTOR INDUSTRIAL BASESPATIAL LOGICAGRARIAN RECOVERY FIRST, INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION NEXT

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DEFINITION / COMPONENTS

- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
- SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

TRIGGER / MECHANISM

- SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next
- TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans

EFFECT / INTERVENTION

- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
- SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans.

07

STAGE 07

WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTED

WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTEDUNEVEN IRRIGATIONGREEN REVOLUTION GAINS STAYED REGIONALLY SELECTIVEINDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATIONPORTS, METROS AND CORRIDORS PULLED AHEADCONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPSIINTERIORS REMAINED INFRASTRUCTURE-POOR

BALANCED REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT STAYED INCOMPLETE

UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selectiveINDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled aheadCONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poorOUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective	CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor	UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead	OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete	INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS

- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

TRIGGER / MECHANISM

- CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor
- OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

EFFECT / INTERVENTION

- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor.

08

STAGE 08

PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITI

PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITIPLANNING COMMISSIONCENTRALISED PLAN FORMULATION AND OUTLAY LOGICNITI AAYOGTHINK-TANK COORDINATION, COMPETITIVE AND COOPERATIVE FEDERALISMPPLAN DOCUMENTSLONG-HORIZON ALLOCATION FRAMEWORK

INDICATOR MONITORING AND MISSION-MODE COMPARISON

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic	PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework	PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism	DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison	NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS

- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

TRIGGER / MECHANISM

- PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework
- DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison

EFFECT / INTERVENTION

- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism.

09

STAGE 09

DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDER

DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDERSTATE AVERAGEUSEFUL BUT HIDES INTERNAL INEQUALITYDISTRICT TARGETINGASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS BRINGS LAGGING DISTRICTS INTO FOCUSBLOCK TARGETINGSCALE MOVES FURTHER DOWNWARD WHERE DISTRICT AVERAGES STILL HIDE

GEOGRAPHIC LESSON

STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality

DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focusBLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gapsGEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality	BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps	STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality
DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus	GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem	DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS

- STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality
- DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus

TRIGGER / MECHANISM

- BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps
- GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem

EFFECT / INTERVENTION

- STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality
- DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem.

DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDERSTATE AVERAGEUSEFUL BUT HIDES INTERNAL INEQUALITYDISTRICT TARGETINGASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS BRINGS LAGGING DISTRICTS INTO FOCUSBLOCK TARGETINGSCALE MOVES FURTHER DOWNWARD WHERE DISTRICT AVERAGES STILL HIDE

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TRIGGER / MECHANISM

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EFFECT / INTERVENTION

STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequalityDISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem.

10

STAGE 10SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKING

SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKINGSDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24OVERALL INDIA SCORE 71TERRITORIAL INDICATORSDEVELOPMENT IS RANKED SPATIALLY, NOT ONLY NATIONALLYCURRENT STYLEDASHBOARDS COMPLEMENT MISSIONS AND PROGRAMME CONVERGENCESAFE USE

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS

SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally

TRIGGER / MECHANISM

CURRENT STYLE → dashboards complement missions and programme convergenceSAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity

EFFECT / INTERVENTION

SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS

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TRIGGER / MECHANISM

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EFFECT / INTERVENTION

SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity.

11

STAGE 11REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINE

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINEDISPARITY VERSUS DIVERSITY AND THE MEANING OF REGIONAL PLANNINGGROWTH POLE, CORE-PERIPHERY, SPREAD AND BACKWASH1938 COMMITTEE, FIRST PLAN, SECOND PLAN, NITI TRANSITION

DISTRICT DASHBOARDS MATTER BECAUSE STATE AVERAGES CONCEAL DISPARITY

DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning

EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition

QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

SYSTEM / DEFINITION

DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planningEXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

PROCESS / MECHANISM

TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transitionQUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN

DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planningEXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE

TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transitionQUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity.

E

EXTRASUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENTONE INTERPRETATION SAYS INDIA HAS MOVED FROM CENTRALISED FIVE-YEARANOTHER SAYS THE UNDERLYING ISSUE REMAINS THE SAMEHOW TO REDUCEREGIONAL IMBALANCE IN LAGGING DISTRICTS, SMALL TOWNS, TRIBAL BELTS

A GOOD MAINS ANSWER SHOULD THEREFORE TREAT NITI ASA THE PLANNING COMMISSION WAS REPLACED BY NITI AAYOG ONTHE TWELFTH PLAN WAS THE LAST FIVE-YEAR PLAN CYCLE.

OPTIONAL PROCESS DEPTH

CAUTION: One interpretation says India has moved from centralised Five-Year Plans to more flexible mission-based and state-compared governance.CAUTION: Another says the underlying issue remains the same: how to reduce regional imbalance in lagging districts, small towns, tribal belts and infrastructure-poor interiors.CAUTION: A good Mains answer should therefore treat NITI as a change in planning style, not the end of planning geography.

DATA / INSTITUTION LIMIT

The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015.The Twelfth Plan was the last Five-Year Plan cycle.Balanced regional development remained an explicit concern but an incomplete achievement.Aspirational Districts Programme targets districts, not states as a whole.

CONTEMPORARY PARALLEL

SDG India Index is a territorial-development benchmarking tool.NOT: NITI Aayog is simply the Planning Commission with a new name - The institutional style and policy mechanism changed significantly.NOT: Ending Five-Year Plans ended planning - Planning continues through missions, indices, state coordination and targeted programmes.NOT: Regional imbalance is only about poor states - It also exists within states, between districts and between metros and hinterlands.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.